HOW TO PLAY

Starting the Game

Four strangers, one castle, and the wilds beyond

Create a party of four adventurers to go and find allies within the strange new land you find yourselves in. The last castle stands at the edge of the wilds. Beyond its walls lie rat-choked roads, haunted woods and worse, and everything out there would happily see you dead.

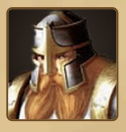
RAISE YOUR PARTY

1. **CHOOSE A QUEST SLOT.** You can keep up to five quests going at once, each with its own party. Every quest saves itself as you play and carries on exactly where you left it. There is no going back, so choose with care.
2. **PICK FOUR HEROES.** Any mix of the six classes, and the same class more than once if you like. Give each hero a name.
3. **FATE ROLLS THEIR STATS.** Each hero's stats are rolled with their class's dice, and there are no rerolls.
4. **ENTER THE CASTLE.** The party sets out with a purse of 5 GP or more for each hero.

THE SIX CLASSES *each has a full page later in this booklet*



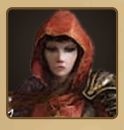
FIGHTER
Front-line warrior
Master of every blade, last to fall



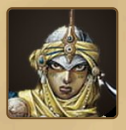
DWARF
Front-line defender
Stubborn as stone, twice as hard to break



ELF
Spellblade
Blade in one hand, spell in the other



MAGIC USER
Spellcaster
Words of power, a body of paper



CLERIC
Healer and protector
Faith as a shield, healing in their hands



THIEF
Skirmisher
Quick hands, quicker feet

WHAT EACH HERO STARTS WITH

CLASS	WEAPONS	SPELLS IN THE SPELLBOOK
Fighter	A trusty Sword of their own, Sling	Fighters cannot cast spells
Dwarf	A trusty Axe of their own, Sling	Dwarves cannot cast spells
Elf	A trusty Spear of their own, Sling	Elves may use some magic but start with none
Magic User	Staff	Magic Missile, Magic Missile
Cleric	Staff, Sling	Undead Ward, Cure Light Wounds
Thief	Dagger, Sling	High level Thieves may use some magic but start with none

A GOOD FIRST PARTY. A Fighter or Dwarf to hold the front, a Cleric to keep everyone standing, a Magic User for raw spell power and a Thief for speed and luck. Put your toughest heroes in the first two places: monsters go for the front of the party far more often than the back.

HOW TO PLAY

Playing the Game

Out into the wilds, and back again

Travel through the wilds fighting monsters and gaining treasures, then return to the castle to equip yourselves with stronger weapons and spells from its shops. Each area of the wilds is tougher than the last, and its monsters guard better rewards.

IN THE CASTLE

The Inn

A safe night behind the walls. Everyone wakes at full health with every spell restored, level 2 spells included.

Weapon & Armour Shop

Better steel and heavier armour. Finer wares appear as your party grows in fame.

Magic Shop

Scrolls that teach new spells to your casters.

Blacksmith

Polishes worn weapons and armour back to their best.

The Clerics

Heal the party, cleanse ailments and raise the fallen, free of charge.

The Caravan

Takes you straight to any place you have already visited.

Party & gear

Equip weapons and armour, fill spellbooks and set the marching order.

IN THE WILDS

Explore

Time moves on until something finds you: monsters, a scrap of lore, a hidden cache or a chest.

Make camp

Rest for as many hours as you choose. Each hour heals every living hero D3 HP (D3+1 with a living Cleric). 8 hours restores level 1 spells; 16 hours restores level 2 spells too. The longer you rest, the more likely something finds you, and an ambush always strikes first.

Return to the castle

Head home to heal, shop and sleep. The road back is not always quiet.

MONSTERS APPROACH

When monsters find you, you see who is coming and choose to **Fight** or **Flee**. A party that flees wins no experience or treasure, and if the escape fails the monsters strike first.

IN BATTLE

On each hero's turn you can **Attack** with their melee weapon, **Shoot** with a sling or bow, **Cast** a spell from their spellbook, **Wait**, or try to **Flee**. Hover over an enemy to see the **Roll needed** to hit it, the damage you would deal and the chance of any ailment. The Combat pages explain every roll.

MARCHING ORDER

The first two heroes in the party stand at the front and take most of the blows: monsters attack them about three times as often as the two at the back. Drag the hero cards in **Party & gear** to change the order.

WHEN HEROES FALL

A hero at 0 HP falls and takes no further part in the battle. If the rest of the party wins, the fallen hero earns only a tenth of their experience, and stays down until the Clerics raise them.

If the whole party falls, a passing caravan carries them back to the castle. Thieves take half your gold on the way, and your gear takes a beating.

GROWING STRONGER

Every monster defeated earns experience, and heroes level up all the way to level 10, rolling new stats and HP each time. Spend your gold on better weapons, armour and scrolls, and push on into deeper, deadlier places. Once your party has outgrown an area, monsters there find you less often.

YOUR HEROES

Player Stats

Steel, sinew, wits and nerve

ARMOUR CLASS (AC)

AC is how hard a hero is to hit. An attacker rolls a D20 and adds their to-hit bonus; if the total equals or beats your AC, the blow lands. The higher the armour class, the harder your character is to hit.

WHERE AC COMES FROM		AC
Base	Every hero starts at 10.	10
Dexterity	Quick heroes are harder to pin down (see the table below).	+0 to +4
Armour	Leather armour +2, chain mail +4, plate mail +6.	+2 to +6
Shield	For the classes that can carry one.	+1
Shooting from range	A hero who attacks with a sling or bow keeps their distance until their next turn.	+2
Worn armour	Battered or ruined armour and shields protect less (see Wear and repair).	−1 or −2

Protection against Evil does not raise AC: it halves the damage the warded hero takes instead. Sleep and Entangle make an enemy easier to hit by lowering its AC.

THE SIX STATS

STRENGTH *The weight behind every blow. The wilds respect only what they cannot push aside.*
Adds to the damage of every weapon blow, melee or ranged.

CONSTITUTION *The grit to keep breathing long after the road has bled you dry.*
Adds bonus HP upon level up.

INTELLIGENCE *A trained and hungry mind that bends raw power into fire and lightning.*
Adds to every damage spell (the Elf and Thief add half, and Fireball half again), and each point adds 1% to the chance of Sleep and Entangle.

DEXTERITY *Quick hands and quicker feet decide whether a blade glances off or finds its mark.*
Adds to every weapon attack roll, and to AC.

WISDOM *An old, quiet knowing that steadies a healer's hand over torn flesh.*
Adds to every healing spell. The Elf and Thief add half.

CHARISMA *A steady gaze and a silver tongue, worth more than coin in a hungry land.*
Adds up to 5 GP to the starting purse. In time it will also sway shop prices and encounters.

WHAT EACH SCORE IS WORTH

SCORE	STR DAMAGE	DEX TO HIT	DEX AC	CON HP PER LEVEL	WIS HEALING	INT SPELL DAMAGE
0–7	+0	+0	+0	+0	+0	+0
8–12	+1	+1	+0	+1	+1	+1
13–14	+2	+2	+1	+2	+D3+1	+D3+2
15	+3	+2	+1	+2	+D3+1	+D3+2
16–17	+3	+2	+2	+D6+2	+D3+3	+D3+4
18–19	+4	+3	+2	+2D6	+D6+2	+D6+4
20	+5	+3	+3	+D12+1	+D6+3	+D6+5
21–23	+6	+4	+3	+D12+2	+D6+4	+D6+6
24	+7	+4	+4	+D12+2	+D6+4	+D6+6
25	+8	+5	+4	+D12+3	+D6+5	+D6+7

Every stat can reach 25 unless the class page shows a lower Limit. Dice bonuses are rolled fresh each time: a Wisdom of 16 adds D3+3 to every heal.

STATUS AILMENTS

Weapons, spells and monsters can leave a target suffering long after the blow. An ailment only takes hold when the attack that carries it hits.

AILMENT	WHAT IT DOES	LASTS
POISON	Takes D3 damage at the start of each of its turns (some monsters' poison bites harder).	3 turns
BURN	Takes D3 damage as the flames catch, then takes 15% more damage from every source (except **POISON**).	3 turns
SHOCK	Reels from the jolt and loses its next turn.	1 turn
Sleep	Cannot act. A sleeping enemy is 15% easier to hit. Any non-magical damage wakes the sleeper.	2 turns
Entangle	Bound fast and cannot act. An entangled enemy is 25% easier to hit, and damage does not free it.	3 turns

- **One of each.** A target can suffer several different ailments at once, but only one of each kind. Suffering the same one again starts it over from the beginning.
- **Where they come from.** Fireball can BURN and Lightning Bolt can SHOCK; Sleep and Entangle are spells of their own. The Legendary blades carry BURN, SHOCK or POISON, and many monsters bring their own. Some foes cannot be harmed by them: fire giants do not burn, and the strongest foes shrug off Sleep and Entangle.
- **Curing them.** SHOCK, Sleep and Entangle end with the battle, but POISON and BURN follow a hero into the next fight until they run their course. Cure Ailment clears every ailment at once, and the Clerics in the castle cleanse the whole party for free.

HELPFUL EFFECTS

Warded	Protection against Evil: takes half damage from every source for 2 turns.
Resistant	Cure Ailment: a 25% chance to shrug off any new ailment for 2 turns.

WEAR AND REPAIR *steel rusts, leather splits, and the wilds take their toll*

Weapons, armour and shields wear while you play in the wilds and caves: a little for every real minute spent exploring or fighting there. Nothing wears in the castle or in camp, or while the game is not on screen. Wear shows on each item's picture as rust, chips and dried blood (updated when you make camp), and hovering over any item shows its durability and any penalty.

DURABILITY	HOURS IN THE WILDS	WEAPON PENALTY	ARMOUR PENALTY
Pristine	0–2	—	—
Scuffed	2–4	—	—
Worn	4–6	—	—
Chipped	6–8	−1 damage	—
Battered	8–10	−1 to hit, −1 damage	Leather, Chain mail, Plate mail −1 AC
Ruined	10+	−1 to hit, −2 damage	Leather, Shield −1 AC; Chain mail, Plate mail −2 AC

- **Hard use.** Each enemy a weapon kills costs it 1% durability (spells and ailments cost nothing). When a hero falls, their armour and shield each lose 1–10%.
- **Worse when worn.** Once an item drops to 45% durability or below, it wears 25% faster from everything.
- **Repairs.** The Blacksmith polishes any item back to Pristine for a tenth of its shop price (at least 1 GP).
- **Fresh gear.** Wear belongs to the item: anything newly bought or found starts clean. A hit always deals at least 1 damage, however worn the blade.

THE RULES OF BATTLE

Combat

Steel, spells and the roll of the dice

WHO GOES FIRST

Initiative is rolled once, as battle begins, and holds for the whole fight. Heroes line up highest level first, and so do monsters (equal levels in a random order). The two lines are then merged: the next hero goes before the next monster with the chance below.

HERO AGAINST MONSTER	HERO FIRST
Hero is higher level	Always
Same level	60%
Monster 1 level higher	50%
Monster 2 levels higher	30%
Monster 3 levels higher	15%
Monster 4 levels higher	8%
Monster 5 or more levels higher	4%

A monster never takes two turns in a row while a hero is still waiting to act. In an ambush, or after a failed escape, every monster acts before the party in the first round.

ROLLING TO HIT

14 + DEX + WEAPON ≥ ENEMY AC

D20	The roll itself, 1 to 20.
Dexterity	+0 to +5, from the hero's DEX score.
Weapon	Each weapon's To hit, from +0 (Staff) to +4 (the Legendary blades).
Wear	A battered or ruined weapon takes −1.

- **Natural 20** always hits, and is a critical hit. **Natural 1** always misses. A Thief's natural 15 or higher always hits and crits.
- **Roll needed.** Hover over an enemy to see the lowest roll that hits it. Each point of to-hit bonus adds 5% to your chance; each point of AC takes 5% away.
- **Spells never miss.** Only Sleep and Entangle can fail, on their own chance.
- **Monsters** roll the same way: a D20 plus their to-hit against your AC. Some fight better in packs.

ROLLING DAMAGE *only rolled when the blow lands*

Weapon dice	The weapon's Damage, rolled each blow: a Sword rolls D3+1.
Strength	+0 to +8, from the hero's STR score.
Wear	Chipped or battered −1, ruined −2.
Against the undead	Maces and hammers deal 50% more.
Critical hit	50% more, rounded down.
BURN on the target	15% more from every source.
Warded target	Half damage.

Every hit deals at least 1 damage, and every critical hit at least 2.

FOR EXAMPLE

A Fighter with Strength 16 swings a Sword: **D3+1** from the blade and **+3** for Strength, so **D3+4**, or 5 to 7 damage. On a critical hit, a roll of 7 becomes 10.

SPELLS

Damage spells roll their own dice and add the caster's Intelligence bonus; healing spells add the Wisdom bonus. The Elf and Thief add half the bonus. Fireball adds half again, then splashes half its damage onto every other enemy.

MONSTERS

Each monster rolls its own damage dice. Monsters never land critical hits: a natural 20 always hits them home, but for normal damage.

A BLOW, STEP BY STEP

ROLL TO HIT — A D20 plus your bonuses against the enemy's AC.

ROLL DAMAGE — Only on a hit: the weapon's dice plus Strength.

DODGE? — A Thief may evade, a Dwarf's stone skin may soften the blow.

AILMENTS — Any ailment the blow carries takes hold.

AGAIN? — On a Double Strike, the second blow rolls all over again.



CRITICAL HITS

A natural 20 on the to-hit roll always hits and deals **50% more damage**, rounded down, and at least 2. A Thief crits on any natural 15 or higher. A few rare weapons crit on a wider range. Monsters never crit.



DOUBLE STRIKE

Before each melee attack, a separate D20 is rolled. On a natural 20 the hero strikes **twice**, and each blow rolls to hit on its own. A Thief strikes twice on 15 or higher. Not for ranged attacks, spells or monsters, although some monsters attack twice every turn.



DODGES AND DAMAGE REDUCTION

Some blows can be dodged. The **Thief** evades 5% of non-magical hits at level 1, rising 1% a level to 14%. The **Dwarf's** stone skin has a 3% chance of reducing incoming damage by 1 from non-magical hits, rising to 12%. A few monsters slip blows too, and rare blades can parry.

EXPERIENCE *XP is earned for every monster the party defeats*

Monster level	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
XP	10	20	35	55	80	115	160	220	300	400

- **The killing blow.** The hero who brings a monster down earns 80% of its XP; the other three share the rest. An area spell that kills several monsters earns its caster 80% of each.
- **Catching up.** A hero below the party's average level earns 12.5% more XP for each level behind.
- **Falling short.** A hero who falls during a battle the party wins earns only 10% of their share. Fleeing or a party wipe earns nothing.
- **Levelling up.** Each new level rolls fresh stats and HP from the class's dice, and spellbooks gain slots.

Reach level	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Total XP	50	170	430	850	1,450	2,500	4,200	6,850	11,850

GOLD AND TREASURE *the spoils of a hard-won fight*

Every monster you defeat may leave nothing, a purse of gold, or an item: a weapon, a piece of armour or a scroll. The stronger the monster, the more gold it carries and the finer its gear, and the mightiest can drop two lots of treasure.

Rarest of all are the **unique weapons**: named blades, each made for one class, that drop at most once in a whole quest. Anything you no longer need sells back to any shop for 15% of its price.

Fleeing a battle wins no treasure. A party wipe costs half your gold.

FLEEING

Any hero can try to flee on their turn, using that turn. The chance rests on how quick the party is against how strong the monsters still standing are, so a nimble party slips away more easily. If the attempt fails, the turn is lost. A fleeing party wins no experience or treasure, and some battles cannot be fled at all.

AMBUSHES

Monsters that catch the party resting, or that cut off a failed escape before battle, strike first: every one of them acts before the party in the first round. Ambushed heroes find it far harder to get away. Rest somewhere safe, like the Inn, when you can.

CHARACTER CLASS

The Fighter

Master of every blade, last to fall



ROLE
Front-line warrior

PLAY STYLE
Simple and direct

The Fighter is a professional warrior, trained with every weapon in the armoury. Where others rely on spells or tricks, the Fighter trusts steel and a thick hide, standing at the front to take the blows meant for their friends.

STRENGTHS

- Hits harder and more often than any other hero
- The only class able to wield **Legendary** blades
- Very tough, with HP that keeps climbing every level
- Easy to play: pick the best weapon and charge

STRUGGLES

- Cannot use magic of any kind
- No way to heal, so relies on the Cleric and potions
- Fights one enemy at a time, so large groups wear it down
- Dexterity tops out at 20, so armour does most of the defending

AT A GLANCE *a typical level 10 Fighter*



ABILITIES

DOUBLE STRIKE

Roll a D20 before each melee attack. On a natural 20 you strike twice.

WEAPON MASTER

The only class that can wield every weapon, right up to Legendary blades.

WEAPONS AND ARMOUR

Can wield any weapon and wear any armour.

STATS AND GROWTH

STAT	PER LEVEL	TYPICAL AT LEVEL 10	LIMIT
Strength *Extra damage with weapons*	D3	21	25
Dexterity *Hitting more often, harder to hit*	D3	19	20
Constitution *Extra HP every level*	D6	25	25
Wisdom *Stronger healing spells*	0	0	—
Intelligence *Stronger damage spells*	0	0	—
Charisma *A fuller starting purse*	+1	12	25
Hit Points *How much damage you can take*	**D3+1 + CON bonus**	**92**	—

Dice show what you roll. "0–1" means roll to gain nothing or one point. Typical at level 10 shows an average hero; yours may roll higher or lower. The Limit is the highest a stat can ever reach.

CHARACTER CLASS

The Dwarf

Stubborn as stone, twice as hard to break



ROLE
Front-line defender

PLAY STYLE
Steady and forgiving

Dwarves are born to the forge and the mountain hall. Short, broad and stubborn, a Dwarf shrugs off blows that would fell a taller warrior and answers with a heavy hammer or axe.

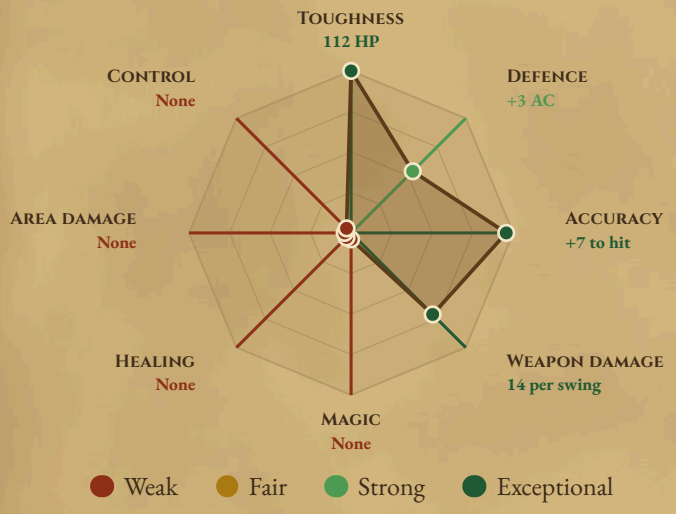
STRENGTHS

- The toughest hero of all, with the most HP of any class
- Wields almost every weapon, up to Superior warhammers and broad swords
- Hits often, thanks to steady Dexterity growth
- Forgiving to play: very hard to knock down

STRUGGLES

- Cannot use magic of any kind
- Cannot wield Legendary weapons
- Strength tops out at 20, so hits a little softer than a Fighter
- Gruff and charmless: Charisma barely grows

AT A GLANCE *a typical level 10 Dwarf*



ABILITIES

DOUBLE STRIKE

Roll a D20 before each melee attack. On a natural 20 you strike twice.

STONEBORN

Gains the biggest HP roll of any class each level: D3+2 plus the Constitution bonus.

STONE SKIN

A 3% chance to reduce non-magical attack damage by 1, rising 1% a level to 12%. Never reduces a hit below 1.

WEAPONS AND ARMOUR

Can wear any armour and carry a shield, but cannot wield Legendary weapons.

STATS AND GROWTH

STAT	PER LEVEL	TYPICAL AT LEVEL 10	LIMIT
Strength *Extra damage with weapons*	D3	19	20
Dexterity *Hitting more often, harder to hit*	D3	21	25
Constitution *Extra HP every level*	D6+1	25	25
Wisdom *Stronger healing spells*	0	0	—
Intelligence *Stronger damage spells*	0	0	—
Charisma *A fuller starting purse*	0–1	4	25
Hit Points *How much damage you can take*	**D3+2 + CON bonus**	**112**	—

Dice show what you roll. "0–1" means roll to gain nothing or one point. Typical at level 10 shows an average hero; yours may roll higher or lower. The Limit is the highest a stat can ever reach.

CHARACTER CLASS

The Elf

Blade in one hand, spell in the other



Elves walk between two worlds: trained with sword and bow, yet touched by old magic. An Elf starts as a nimble skirmisher and, from level 3, begins to weave spells from both the arcane and holy traditions.

STRENGTHS

- ✦ Learns spells from both the Magic User and Cleric lists
- ✦ Strong area magic and crowd control in later levels
- ✦ Good HP for a spellcaster
- ✦ Can fight from range with a bow

STRUGGLES

- × No spells until level 3, and only a few slots before level 10
- × Light weapon damage, limited to Standard weapons
- × Adds only half its Intelligence or Wisdom bonus to spells
- × Defence and accuracy trail the warriors

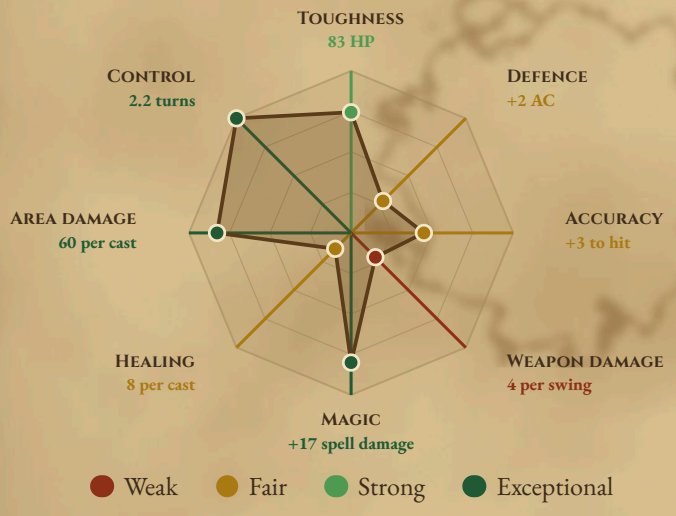
ROLE

Spellblade

PLAY STYLE

Flexible, grows into its power

AT A GLANCE *a typical level 10 Elf*



ABILITIES

DOUBLE STRIKE

Roll a D20 before each melee attack. On a natural 20 you strike twice.

TWIN TRADITIONS

Spell slots open at level 3 and grow to 6 by level 10: five level 1 slots and one level 2 slot. Can use Magic User and Cleric spells, but cannot use level 2 Cleric spells.

WEAPONS AND ARMOUR

Can wear up to chain mail armour and carry a shield, but cannot use Advanced, Superior or Legendary weapons.

STATS AND GROWTH

STAT	PER LEVEL	TYPICAL AT LEVEL 10	LIMIT
Strength *Extra damage with weapons*	1–2	16	25
Dexterity *Hitting more often, harder to hit*	1–2	16	25
Constitution *Extra HP every level*	D6	25	25
Wisdom *Stronger healing spells*	D3+1	25	25
Intelligence *Stronger damage spells*	D3+1	25	25
Charisma *A fuller starting purse*	+1	11	25
Hit Points *How much damage you can take*	**D3 + CON bonus**	**83**	—

Dice show what you roll. "0–1" means roll to gain nothing or one point. Typical at level 10 shows an average hero; yours may roll higher or lower. The Limit is the highest a stat can ever reach.

CHARACTER CLASS

The Magic User

Words of power, a body of paper



The Magic User has traded the sword for the spellbook. Years of study let them hurl bolts of force, fire and lightning, or send enemies to sleep. Their spells never miss, but they must be protected.

STRENGTHS

- The strongest spell damage in the game, and spells always hit
- Fireball and Lightning Bolt strike whole groups
- Sleep and Entangle take enemies out of the fight
- Starts ready to cast, with two Magic Missiles

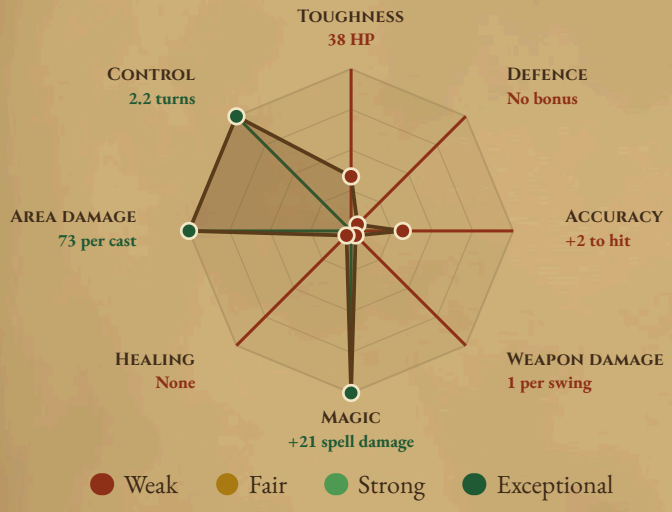
STRUGGLES

- Very low HP: a few good blows will bring them down
- Basic weapons only, and barely hurts with them
- One cast per spellbook slot, then must rest
- Must buy or find scrolls to learn new spells

ROLE
Spellcaster

PLAY STYLE
Powerful but fragile

AT A GLANCE *a typical level 10 Magic User*



ABILITIES

ARCANE KNOWLEDGE

Starts with Magic Missile in both of its 2 slots. Grows to 7 slots by level 10, with level 2 spells from level 5. Each slot is one cast per rest.

MAGIC MASTERY

Can learn all Magic User spells.

WEAPONS AND ARMOUR

Can only use Basic weapons and cannot wear armour or carry a shield, although some rare magic armour may exist...

STATS AND GROWTH

STAT	PER LEVEL	TYPICAL AT LEVEL 10	LIMIT
Strength *Extra damage with weapons*	0–1	6	18
Dexterity *Hitting more often, harder to hit*	0–2	11	25
Constitution *Extra HP every level*	0–2	12	25
Wisdom *Stronger healing spells*	D3	19	20
Intelligence *Stronger damage spells*	D6+1	25	25
Charisma *A fuller starting purse*	+1	12	25
Hit Points *How much damage you can take*	**D4 + CON bonus**	**38**	—

Dice show what you roll. "0–1" means roll to gain nothing or one point. Typical at level 10 shows an average hero; yours may roll higher or lower. The Limit is the highest a stat can ever reach.

CHARACTER CLASS

The Cleric

Faith as a shield, healing in their hands



The Cleric is a warrior of faith who keeps the party standing. With mace and prayer they mend wounds, cure **POISON** and curses, and shield allies from harm. Against the undead, their faith becomes a weapon.

STRENGTHS

- By far the best healer, and can heal the whole party at once
- Protects allies and cures every ailment
- Holy spells hit the undead hard
- Sturdy for a spellcaster, with good HP

STRUGGLES

- Light weapon damage, limited to Basic and Light weapons
- No area damage, so swarms are a problem
- Damage spells only work against the undead
- Cannot cast Magic User spells

ROLE

Healer and protector

PLAY STYLE

Supportive

AT A GLANCE *a typical level 10 Cleric*



ABILITIES

DOUBLE STRIKE

Roll a D20 before each melee attack. On a natural 20 you strike twice.

PRAYERS

Starts with Undead Ward and Cure Light Wounds. Grows to 10 slots by level 10, with up to 4 level 2 spells.

HOLY SPELLS

Can learn all Cleric spells.

FIELD MEDIC

While the Cleric is alive, the whole party heals D3+1 HP per hour of camp rest instead of D3.

WEAPONS AND ARMOUR

Can wear up to chain mail armour but cannot carry a shield. Can only wield Basic and Light weapons.

STATS AND GROWTH

STAT	PER LEVEL	TYPICAL AT LEVEL 10	LIMIT
Strength *Extra damage with weapons*	1–2	16	20
Dexterity *Hitting more often, harder to hit*	1–2	16	20
Constitution *Extra HP every level*	D6	25	25
Wisdom *Stronger healing spells*	D6+1	25	25
Intelligence *Stronger damage spells*	D3	19	20
Charisma *A fuller starting purse*	D3	21	25
Hit Points *How much damage you can take*	**D3 + CON bonus**	**83**	—

Dice show what you roll. "0–1" means roll to gain nothing or one point. Typical at level 10 shows an average hero; yours may roll higher or lower. The Limit is the highest a stat can ever reach.

CHARACTER CLASS

The Thief

Quick hands, quicker feet



The Thief survives on speed, cunning and a little luck. Hard to pin down and quick with a dagger, they slip past blows that would land on anyone else and strike where it hurts most.

STRENGTHS

- The hardest hero to hit, and dodges some attacks entirely
- Rolls of 15 or more always hit and crit
- Strikes twice far more often than anyone else
- Highest Charisma, great for shops and encounters

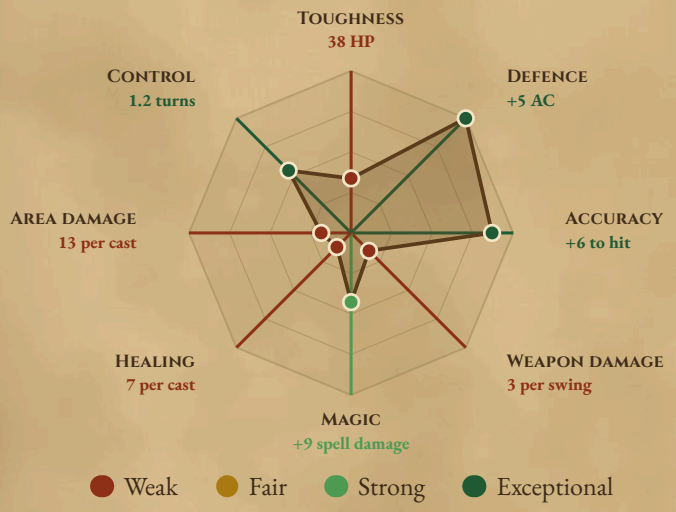
STRUGGLES

- Very low HP, so cannot trade blows for long
- Basic weapons only, so each hit is small
- No spells until level 6, and only a few after
- Adds only half its Intelligence or Wisdom bonus to spells

ROLE
Skirmisher

PLAY STYLE
Tricky, rewards luck

AT A GLANCE *a typical level 10 Thief*



ABILITIES

EVASION
A 5% chance to dodge non-magical hits, rising 1% a level to 14%.

KEEN STRIKES
A natural 15 or higher always hits and crits.

QUICK HANDS
Double Strike on a 15+, not just a natural 20.

LIGHT FINGERS
Only a party with a Thief can open the trapped chests found on the road.

DABBLER
Spell slots from level 6, from either spell list.

WEAPONS AND ARMOUR

Can only wear leather armour and cannot carry a shield. Can only wield Basic weapons.

STATS AND GROWTH

STAT	PER LEVEL	TYPICAL AT LEVEL 10	LIMIT
Strength *Extra damage with weapons*	0–2	12	25
Dexterity *Hitting more often, harder to hit*	D3+1	25	25
Constitution *Extra HP every level*	0–2	12	25
Wisdom *Stronger healing spells*	D3	21	25
Intelligence *Stronger damage spells*	D3	21	25
Charisma *A fuller starting purse*	D6+1	25	25
Hit Points *How much damage you can take*	**D4 + CON bonus**	**38**	—

Dice show what you roll. "0–1" means roll to gain nothing or one point. Typical at level 10 shows an average hero; yours may roll higher or lower. The Limit is the highest a stat can ever reach.

SPELLBOOK

The Magic User's Spellbook

Seven pages of power, earned one level at a time



☐ Slot, with the level it unlocks ☐ May hold a level 2 spell *Shown: an example level 10 Magic User*

HOW THE SPELLBOOK GROWS



Character level

LEVEL	1	2–3	4	5–6	7–9	10
SLOTS	2	3	4	5	6	7
✦ LEVEL 2	—	—	—	1	2	2

USING YOUR SPELLBOOK

- **LEARNING.** You can learn every Magic User spell. Buy scrolls in the shop or find them as loot; there is no limit to how many you know.
- **SLOTS.** Only spells written into your spellbook slots can be cast. Choose which spells fill your slots to suit the fight ahead.
- **CASTING.** Each filled slot gives one cast. Once cast, that slot is spent until the party rests.
- **DOUBLES.** The same spell may fill more than one slot. You begin with Magic Missile in both of your first two slots.
- **LEVEL 2 SPELLS.** Only slots marked ✦ may hold a level 2 spell.
- **ALWAYS HITS.** Spells never miss. Damage spells add your Intelligence bonus.

MAGIC USER SPELLS

SPELL	LVL	DESCRIPTION	EFFECT
Magic Missile	1	*Darts of pure force leap from the caster's fingertips and never stray from their mark.*	D6+1 magic damage to one target.
Fireball	1	*A spark swells into a roaring sphere of flame that bursts among the enemy ranks.*	D8 magic fire damage, plus half the caster's INT bonus, to the chosen enemy. Every other enemy takes half of that. Each enemy hit has a 10% chance to **BURN**.
Sleep	1	*A whispered lullaby drags the mind into a heavy, dreamless slumber.*	One target sleeps for 2 turns. Chance: 40% +1% per INT vs level 5 and below, 15% +1% per INT vs level 6+, never above 85%. Sleepers are 15% easier to hit; non-magical damage wakes them. May not be effective on the strongest of foes.
Advanced Magic Missile	2	*The darts of a master: brighter, heavier, and every bit as unerring.*	D6+8 magic damage to one target.
Lightning Bolt	2	*The sky's fury is called down in a blinding fork that leaps from foe to foe.*	D12+4 magic lightning damage to every enemy, each with a 10% chance to **SHOCK**. Then 5 sparks strike the enemies for a quarter of the damage rolled (sparks cannot **SHOCK**).
Entangle	2	*Grasping roots and thorned vines burst from the ground to bind the enemy fast.*	One target is entangled for 3 turns. Chance: 50% +1% per INT vs level 5 and below, 10% +1% per INT vs level 6+, never above 85%. Entangled targets are 25% easier to hit; damage does not free them. May not be effective on the strongest of foes.

SPELLBOOK

The Cleric's Spellbook

Ten prayers to mend the living and unmake the dead



☐ Slot, with the level it unlocks ☐ May hold a level 2 spell *Shown: an example level 10 Cleric*

HOW THE SPELLBOOK GROWS



Character level

LEVEL	1	2–3	4	5–6	7–8	9	10
SLOTS	2	4	4	5	6	8	10
✦ LEVEL 2	—	—	—	1	2	2	4

USING YOUR SPELLBOOK

- **LEARNING.** You can learn every Cleric spell. Buy scrolls in the shop or find them as loot; there is no limit to how many you know.
- **SLOTS.** Only spells written into your spellbook slots can be cast. Choose which prayers fill your slots to suit the fight ahead.
- **CASTING.** Each filled slot gives one cast. Once cast, that slot is spent until the party rests.
- **DOUBLES.** The same spell may fill more than one slot. You begin with Undead Ward and Cure Light Wounds.
- **LEVEL 2 SPELLS.** Only slots marked ✦ may hold a level 2 spell.
- **ALWAYS LANDS.** Spells never miss. Healing adds your Wisdom bonus; spells against the undead add your Intelligence bonus.

CLERIC SPELLS

SPELL	LVL	DESCRIPTION	EFFECT
Undead Ward	1	*A blinding word of faith that burns through the rotten flesh of the restless dead.*	D6+2 magic damage to one undead enemy. The Cleric also takes D3 damage.
Cure Light Wounds	1	*A gentle prayer that knits torn skin and stems the bleeding.*	Heals one target for D6.
Protection against Evil	1	*A ward of pale light settles over an ally, turning aside the blows meant for them.*	One target takes 50% less damage from all sources for 2 turns.
Cure Ailment	1	*Holy water and a whispered rite to purge whatever festers within.*	Cures all negative ailments (**POISON**, **BURN**, **SHOCK**, sleep, entangle and the rest) and gives 25% resistance to all of them for 2 turns.
Undead Abyss	2	*The Cleric tears open the dark and casts the dead back into it, at a price.*	D12+3 magic damage to one undead enemy. The Cleric also takes D3+1 damage.
Cure Serious Wounds	2	*A fervent invocation that drags the dying back from the brink.*	Heals one target for D12+6.
Cure All	2	*A circle of radiant light washes over every companion at once.*	Heals every ally for D6+2.

THE CITY

Within the Castle Walls

Steel, leather and a warm hearth, for a price

The castle still has plenty of stock of basic weapons and armour, and its smiths and armourers will craft finer wares given time. Some weapons, armour and spells cannot be bought at all: they lie out in the wilderness, waiting to be found. Be sure to stock up before heading out.

THE WEAPON SHOP

Every character can carry one melee and one ranged weapon

WEAPON	TYPE	TO HIT	DAMAGE	SPECIAL	WHO CAN WIELD IT	PRICE
Staff	Melee	+0	+1	—	Everyone	1 GP
Sling	Ranged	+0	+0	+2 AC until your next turn	Everyone	3 GP
Dagger	Melee	+1	+1	—	Everyone	5 GP
Spear	Melee	+2	+1	—	Fighter, Dwarf, Elf, Cleric	10 GP
Mace	Melee	+1	+2	+50% damage to the undead	Fighter, Dwarf, Elf, Cleric	10 GP
Axe	Melee	+1	+D3	—	Fighter, Dwarf, Elf	12 GP
Sword	Melee	+2	+D3+1	—	Fighter, Dwarf, Elf	20 GP
Hammer	Melee	+1	+D6	+50% damage to the undead	Fighter, Dwarf, Elf	20 GP
Bow	Ranged	+1	+1	+2 AC until your next turn	Fighter, Dwarf, Elf	50 GP
Scimitar	Melee	+2	+D6+2	—	Fighter, Dwarf	150 GP
Morning Star	Melee	+0	+D12+3	+50% damage to the undead	Fighter, Dwarf	175 GP
Sabre	Melee	+3	+D6+3	—	Fighter, Dwarf	300 GP
Arming Sword	Melee	+2	+D12+1	—	Fighter, Dwarf	425 GP
Warhammer	Melee	+3	+D20+2	+50% damage to the undead	Fighter, Dwarf	680 GP
Broad Sword	Melee	+3	+D12+6	—	Fighter, Dwarf	750 GP
Ashfang	Melee	+4	D12+12	15% chance to **BURN**	Fighter	3500 GP
Stormcleaver	Melee	+4	D20+8	10% chance to **SHOCK**	Fighter	3750 GP
Oathbreaker	Melee	+4	D6+15	20% chance to **POISON**	Fighter	4500 GP

THE ARMOUR SHOP

Armour and shields add to your AC

ARMOUR	AC	WHO CAN WEAR IT	PRICE
Leather Armour	+2	Fighter, Dwarf, Elf, Cleric, Thief	25 GP
Chain Mail	+4	Fighter, Dwarf, Elf, Cleric	350 GP
Plate Mail	+6	Fighter, Dwarf	1575 GP
Shield	+1	Fighter, Dwarf, Elf	26 GP

The Magic User cannot wear armour or carry a shield, although rare magic armour is rumoured to exist.

THE BLACKSMITH *Polishing and repairs restore worn gear to its best*

Weeks in the wild leave blades chipped and mail rusted, and worn gear fights worse. Bring it to the forge and the smith will polish and repair it for a tenth of its price.

Staff	1 GP	**Sling**	1 GP	**Dagger**	1 GP
Spear	1 GP	**Mace**	1 GP	**Axe**	1 GP
Sword	2 GP	**Hammer**	2 GP	**Bow**	5 GP
Scimitar	15 GP	**Morning Star**	17 GP	**Sabre**	30 GP
Arming Sword	42 GP	**Warhammer**	68 GP	**Broad Sword**	75 GP
Ashfang	350 GP	**Stormcleaver**	375 GP	**Oathbreaker**	450 GP
Leather Armour	2 GP	**Chain Mail**	35 GP	**Plate Mail**	157 GP
Shield	2 GP				

THE MAGIC SHOP *Scrolls to learn and write into your spellbook*

SCROLL	SPELL LIST	LVL	EFFECT	WHO CAN LEARN IT	PRICE
Magic Missile	*Magic User*	1	D6+1 to one enemy	Magic User, Elf, Thief	250 GP
Fireball	*Magic User*	1	D8 + half INT to one, half to the rest, may **BURN**	Magic User, Elf, Thief	750 GP
Sleep	*Magic User*	1	Puts one enemy to sleep	Magic User, Elf, Thief	500 GP
Advanced Magic Missile	*Magic User*	2	D6+8 to one enemy	Magic User, Elf, Thief	1000 GP
Lightning Bolt	*Magic User*	2	D12+4 to every enemy and sparks, may **SHOCK**	Magic User, Elf, Thief	2500 GP
Entangle	*Magic User*	2	Binds one enemy fast	Magic User, Elf, Thief	2500 GP
Undead Ward	*Cleric*	1	D6+2 to one undead	Cleric, Elf, Thief	250 GP
Cure Light Wounds	*Cleric*	1	Heals one for D6	Cleric, Elf, Thief	500 GP
Protection against Evil	*Cleric*	1	Halves damage to one ally	Cleric, Elf, Thief	500 GP
Cure Ailment	*Cleric*	1	Cures all ailments	Cleric, Elf, Thief	250 GP
Undead Abyss	*Cleric*	2	D12+3 to one undead	Cleric, Elf, Thief	1000 GP
Cure Serious Wounds	*Cleric*	2	Heals one for D12+6	Cleric, Elf, Thief	1250 GP
Cure All	*Cleric*	2	Heals every ally for D6+2	Cleric, Elf, Thief	1500 GP

Rarer scrolls may appear on the shelves as your fame grows, and some are only ever found in the wilderness. The Elf's level 2 slot can only hold Magic User spells.

THE CLERICS

The temple's clerics tend to every pilgrim who returns from the wilds. Your party is restored to full health, ailments are cleansed and fallen companions are raised, all free of charge. Raising the fallen takes the night: the whole party rests at the temple and wakes with every spell restored.

THE CARAVAN

Merchant caravans leave the castle gates every day. Take one to any place you have visited before and skip the long walk back through the wilderness.

SELLING

Every shop will buy back anything you no longer need for 15% of its price. Better a few coins than dead weight in the pack.